

Essential Vim Cheat Sheet

● Navigation (Moving Around)

Command	Action
<code>h j k l</code>	Move Left , Down , Up , and Right
<code>0</code>	Jump to the very beginning of the line
<code>^</code>	Jump to the first non-blank character of the line
<code>\$</code>	Jump to the end of the line
<code>w</code>	Move forward to the start of the next word (punctuation is a word)
<code>W</code>	Move forward to the start of the next word (only spaces separate words)
<code>b</code>	Move backward to the start of a word
<code>B</code>	Move backward to the start of a word (only spaces separate words)
<code>e</code>	Move forward to the end of a word
<code>gg</code>	Jump to the first line of the file
<code>G</code>	Jump to the last line of the file
<code>[LineNumber]G</code>	Jump to a specific line number (e.g., <code>42G</code>)
<code>%</code>	Jump to the matching bracket <code>()</code> , <code>[]</code> , or <code>{}</code>
<code>Ctrl + f</code>	Scroll one full page down
<code>Ctrl + b</code>	Scroll one full page up
<code>Ctrl + d</code>	Scroll half page down
<code>Ctrl + u</code>	Scroll half page up

● Editing (Insert & Change)

Command	Action
<code>i</code>	Enter Insert mode at the cursor
<code>I</code>	Enter Insert mode at the beginning of the line
<code>a</code>	Enter Insert mode after the cursor (append)
<code>A</code>	Enter Insert mode at the end of the line
<code>o</code>	Open a new line below the current line and enter Insert mode
<code>O</code>	Open a new line above the current line and enter Insert mode

Command	Action
<code>r</code>	Replace a single character under the cursor
<code>R</code>	Enter Replace mode (overwrites text)
<code>Esc</code>	Exit Insert mode; return to Normal mode

Deleting, Copying & Pasting

Command	Action
<code>x</code>	Delete character under the cursor
<code>dd</code>	Delete (cut) the current line
<code>dw</code>	Delete (cut) from cursor to next word
<code>D</code>	Delete (cut) from cursor to the end of the line
<code>yy</code>	Copy (yank) the current line
<code>y[Number]y</code>	Copy a specific number of lines (e.g., <code>y2y</code>)
<code>p</code>	Paste the deleted/copied text after the cursor
<code>P</code>	Paste the deleted/copied text before the cursor
<code>u</code>	Undo the last action
<code>Ctrl + r</code>	Redo the last undone action
<code>.</code>	Repeat the previous command

Search & Replace

Command	Action
<code>/ {pattern}</code>	Search forward for the pattern
<code>? {pattern}</code>	Search backward for the pattern
<code>n</code>	Repeat search in the same direction
<code>N</code>	Repeat search in the opposite direction
<code>:%s/old/new/g</code>	Replace all occurrences of "old" with "new" in the file
<code>:%s/old/new/gc</code>	Replace all with a prompt for confirmation
<code>gd</code>	Jump to local definition of symbol under cursor
<code>gD</code>	Jump to global definition of symbol under cursor

Visual Mode (Selecting)

Command	Action
v	Enter Visual mode (character-wise selection)
V	Enter Visual Line mode (line-wise selection)
Ctrl + v	Enter Visual Block mode (column selection)
>	Indent selected text
<	De-indent selected text



UI & File Management

Command	Action
:set nu	Turn on line numbers
:set nonu	Disable line numbers
:set relativenumber	Show line numbers relative to cursor position
>>	Indent current line
<<	De-indent current line
:w	Save (write) the file
:wq	Save and Quit
:q!	Quit without saving changes
:x	Save and Quit (only writes if changes were made)